

Brainsquare

The Chronicles
October 2024



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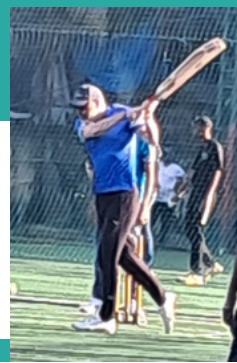
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Autumn



Foreword by Mark Van Hamme

Brainsquare: A Welcoming, Supportive Team



Over the summer, many of you probably followed the Olympic Games. For some of us here in Belgium, it was a unique opportunity—just a train ride away from Paris—to attend the events and support our Belgian individual athletes and teams.

One of the most fascinating aspects of the Olympics is watching team sports and observing how team members interact. Do they smile as they enter the field? Do they communicate, coach each other, and stay united? How do they react when they win... or lose?

We at Brainsquare operate in a different arena, but teamwork is equally critical. How we come together to complete projects, build solutions for our customers, and ensure we have a meaningful, enjoyable experience is vital to our success.

That's why I encourage you to take every opportunity to get to know your colleagues better—both professionally and personally. Our recent "Empowering Event" was a great example. I hope you not only gained valuable insights but also strengthened bonds with your coworkers.

As we continue to grow organically, we welcome new team members, one or a few at a time. I invite you to make them feel at home and give them the opportunity to share their ideas and insights. Think back to your first days at work—those who welcomed you and took the time to talk to you may still be your closest friends here.

As we develop our team skills, we'll be prepared when the opportunity arises to band together with one or more other teams. It's my task to find the right match—a team with a compatible DNA—but it will be our collective responsibility to make the partnership work.

At Brainsquare, we strive to build a welcoming team, where people connect both professionally and personally. Let's continue to be that warm, supportive team and aim for a quite some wins along the way.

Proudly Yours,

Mark Van Hamme

Brainsquare's Empowering Event: a memorable evening of reflection and connection

On September 26th, Brainsquare hosted its Empowering Event at the scenic Brabantse Golf in Melsbroek, on the outskirts of Brussels. The event brought together team members for an evening of reflection, connection, and fun!

The evening started off with a casual gathering over drinks, giving everyone an opportunity to relax and connect after the workday. Following this, we dove into the core of the evening: a series of presentations covering key aspects of Brainsquare's progress and ambitions. These touched on important topics such as:

- Presentation of major new projects
- Partnerships and the value of certifications
- The Bite Size sessions
- Montova sales and e-invoicing
- Finance, timesheets and car mileage
- Recruitment and internship updates
- Move to Cloud, Nexus, Training requests
- A strategy update from Mark

With the formal part of the evening concluded, we enjoyed a reception followed by a walking dinner featuring a variety of culinary delights from Belgium, Italy, and Spain.

The weather wasn't on our side, preventing us from fully appreciating the venue's views of the golf course. But the evening's warm atmosphere and opportunity to connect with colleagues—both familiar and new—made the event a great success.

For those in the Belgian office who couldn't join us, or our colleagues from other locations, you can access the Empowering Event presentation [here](#). It contains valuable insights that we believe will be of interest to all.



A visit to India

In early June, I had the pleasure of visiting one of our offices in India, together with Pieterjan. It was my first time in India, and what an experience it was!

From the moment we stepped out of the airport on Sunday evening, I was struck by the heat, even at that late hour. Thankfully, the car's air conditioning offered some relief as we made our way to the hotel. I quickly learned that Indian drivers have a fondness for honking, and their driving skills are truly unmatched.

The next day at the office, I was warmly greeted by our colleagues. It was wonderful to finally meet face-to-face with many of the people I work with daily. There's something invaluable about in-person conversations, and I spent the day having one-on-one discussions with everyone on my team.

That evening, we enjoyed a delightful dinner with the EAI & Atlassian team to celebrate the successful cloud migration of Atlas Copco's Atlassian tools. This cloud move was a critical project with a strict deadline due to Atlassian's end of support for the server solution. The tremendous efforts of all people involved really deserved a celebratory moment.

This dinner was the highlight of our two-day trip for me. The camaraderie and kindness of everyone were heartwarming, creating a joyful and happy atmosphere. The bond our colleagues share is truly amazing and inspiring. Naturally, we captured the moment with a few photos.

On Tuesday evening, it was already time to head back to Belgium. It was unfortunate we had to leave so soon, as I had truly enjoyed my time there. Nonetheless, I am grateful for the opportunity to visit and look forward to returning in the future.

A special thank you to Kapil, Manesh, and Supriya for taking such good care of us.



Jorden Van Bogaert
Atlassian Service Delivery Manager

Your Car Mileage

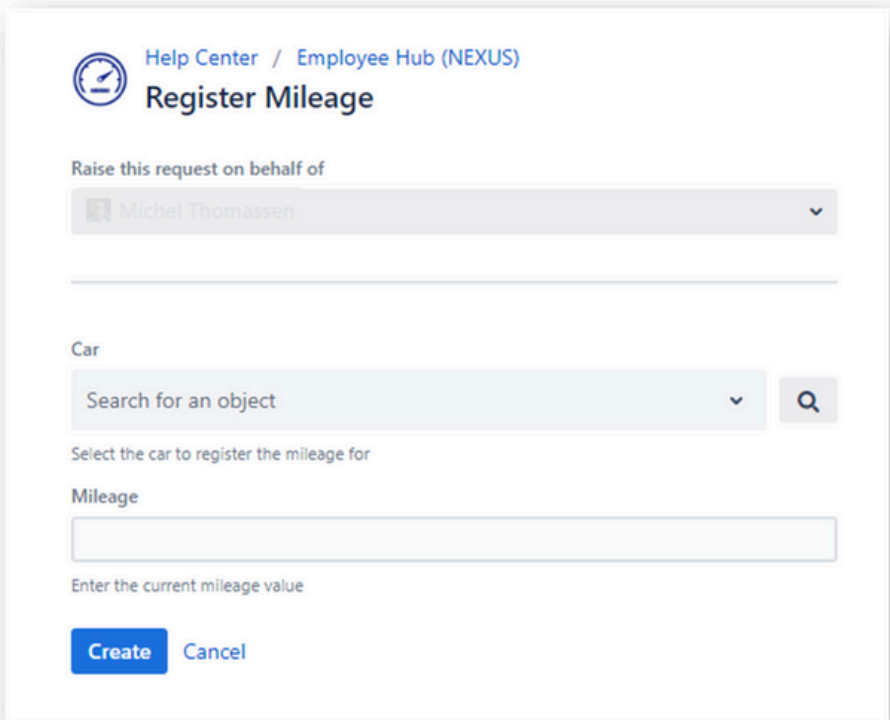
As you may have noticed, Brainsquare Group has chosen the path of the electric car. This doesn't just mean a different kind of refuelling, it's a "new way of driving".

With an electric car, you don't drive to the nearest Shell station to quickly load your car, you have to plan more carefully. Charging at home, charging at work, charging along the road... in the beginning it requires a little more planning. But ultimately it is just another comfortable means to get you from A to B.

The process to follow at Brainsquare is also slightly different. Every month you must now enter your mileage in the Service Desk portal. But don't worry, you will receive a reminder via your Brainsquare Group mailbox. Keep a close eye on your mailbox, otherwise the fleet manager will contact you 😊 The form is easy to complete: select your car based on your license plate and enter your current mileage. Piece of cake.

If you want to know more about the new electric car policy or how it works with the charging stations, check the FAQ on Confluence: <https://confluence.brainsquare.group/display/INTRANET/Car+policy>.

If you can't find the answer you are looking for, feel free to contact one of the coaches at coaches@brainsquare.group or in person.



The screenshot shows a web form titled "Register Mileage" within the "Help Center / Employee Hub (NEXUS)" interface. The form includes a dropdown menu to "Raise this request on behalf of" with "Michel Thomassen" selected. Below this is a "Car" section with a search bar labeled "Search for an object" and a magnifying glass icon. Underneath the search bar is the instruction "Select the car to register the mileage for". The "Mileage" section features a text input field with the prompt "Enter the current mileage value" below it. At the bottom of the form are two buttons: "Create" (in blue) and "Cancel" (in light blue).

Introducing our new Training Request Portal

We are excited to announce the upcoming launch of our new Training Request Portal, designed to streamline the way employees and their team lead request and manage training opportunities. This new portal, accessible via the Central Employee Hub "Nexus," will go live November 1st, 2024. This initiative aims to improve our internal training processes and to support continuous employee development.

Portal Overview

The Training Request Portal is a user-friendly Jira-based platform where employees can request various training types, from formal classroom sessions, self study learning material to tech events and bite-sized sessions. This upgrade from our existing system simplifies the process for both employees and team leads, making it easier to keep track and manage personal growth.

Key Benefits

The new portal offers several key benefits that address current gaps in our training request process:

- **Centralized Requests:** Submit and manage all training requests in one place, eliminating scattered communication like chat, email, or in-person discussions.
- **Standardized Process:** A consistent approach to submitting and tracking training requests, benefiting both requesters and approvers.
- **Enhanced Visibility for Evaluation:** Easily track status of training requests, making it easier to follow up on the enrollment progress and evaluate the impact of completed trainings.
- **Feedback and ROI Tracking:** Provide feedback on training effectiveness to help improve offerings and encourage others to participate.

Go Live Details

The portal will be live November 1st, 2024. We will offer brief trainings in the form of Bite Sized sessions to introduce its features and guide you through the submission process.

Getting Started

Once the portal is live, you can easily register for trainings directly through Nexus, with a straightforward process guiding you from selection to approval.

We believe this portal will not only simplify the training request process but also empower our teams to take charge of their professional growth in a more structured and visible way.

Stay tuned for more details as we approach the launch date. We look forward to seeing how this new tool will help drive our continuous learning culture forward!

Brainsquare / Montova colleagues at the summer festivals



During Summer Festival time in Belgium, some of us “rocked” together!



Ronny - Michel - Bert - Niels - Nathalie

Customers

Montova - Peppol

Starting January 1st, 2026, all Belgian enterprises subject to VAT will be required to use structured electronic invoices for transactions with one another.

These structured electronic invoices will be sent via a decentralised network called Peppol.

Montova is an accredited Peppol Service Provider. Therefore, in a first phase, we are launching a digital campaign towards our existing customers.

The main objectives of this campaign are to create further awareness and to convince them of the benefits of our Montova solution.

An ideal opportunity to strengthen our customer loyalty.

So do not hesitate to share this campaign and info when you are in contact with existing Montova customers or new interesting prospects.

Thomas Van Hoezen
Montova Operations Director



Prepare for the move to Cloud!

Jira and Confluence are essential tools across our organization, supporting everything from customer service and project tracking to meeting notes and timesheet registration. But let's be honest: wouldn't it be great if they were faster?

Good news! The Brainsquare Group is moving Jira and Confluence to the Cloud, and that means big improvements are on the way. Here's a sneak peek at what you can expect:

- Faster performance for a smoother user experience
- New features, including Atlassian Intelligence, to boost productivity
- Single sign-on with Microsoft, so no more outdated usernames and passwords
- Unified login for Office 365 and Atlassian Cloud
- Mobile apps for Jira, Confluence, and timesheets
- And much more!

The Brainsquare Atlassian team is thrilled to make this move, as it will allow us to provide even better support for our internal teams. The new features and other cloud-only products open up exciting new possibilities.

Mark your calendar! The production migration is set for November 2024. Want to learn more and see what's coming? Check out our [Bite-Size Session recording](#)!

Jorden Van Bogaert
Atlassian Service Delivery Manager

Introducing NEXUS: The New Employee Hub

Currently, we have multiple portals on Jira that host various processes, such as the Brainsquare Internal Service Desk and the Montova Internal Service Desk. These are two nearly identical platforms providing the same services but serving different companies within the Brainsquare Group. But what will happen when another company joins? Will we add another portal with the same functionality? And why does the Evaluation Portal exist separately from the rest?

It's time to streamline. Meet [NEXUS](#), the new employee hub designed to bring together all employee-related portals into one centralized portal on Jira. As we migrate to the Cloud, we will also consolidate all internal portals across companies in the Brainsquare Group. The term "nexus" refers to a central point, which aligns perfectly with our goal—being a one-stop shop for all employee services.

Launching in November alongside our cloud migration, [NEXUS](#) will initially combine familiar processes such as holiday requests, expense registration, and purchase requests for products or licenses. Additionally, the Evaluation Portal will be integrated into NEXUS, sporting a fresh, updated look just in time for the 2024 evaluation cycle.

At launch, NEXUS will also introduce new features, such as the Car Mileage registration and Training requests. As we continue to innovate, we plan to add more processes and advanced features, such as AI-powered assistance to help employees navigate processes and find answers to their questions.

We're excited to simplify our current setup. Got feedback? Use NEXUS's feedback option to share your ideas or suggestions for future improvements!

Jorden Van Bogaert
Atlassian Service Delivery Manager

Welcome to the Bite Size Sessions calendar page! Here you'll find a complete list of all our upcoming sessions, along with dates, times, and any additional details you need to know. Our calendar is updated regularly, so be sure to check back often or [subscribe](#) to below calendar to see what new sessions we have coming up.

Planned sessions (DD = Deep Dive; QB = Quick Bite; ES = External Speaker)

Type	Date	Subject	Speaker
QB	📅 17 okt. 2024	Get ready for the Move to Cloud	Jorden Van Bogaert
QB	📅 24 okt. 2024	What is Montova	Wim Vanhooff
QB	📅 7 nov. 2024	Training portal	Rolf Dobbelaere
DD	202412xx	Enterprise Architecture	Geert Judong
QB	202501xx	Agile retrospective	Veronique Decock
QB	202502xx	SQL misconception	Luc Verbeek

Veronique Decock - Michel Thomassen



Welcome to our new colleagues!



April 18th, 2024

Kamlesh Manjrekar - Operations / Data Engineer - B² - India



April 22nd, 2024

Nikhil Angawane - EDI Software Engineer - Montova - India



May 1st, 2024

David Ballesteros - Senior .NET Software Engineer - B² - Belgium



May 2nd, 2024

Rohit Surutkar - Delivery Assistant - Montova - Belgium



July 9th, 2024

Vikrant Shinde - .NET Software Engineer - B² - India



July 18th, 2024

Prasad Patil - .NET Software Engineer - B² - India



August 21st, 2024

Yashwant Mestry - .NET Software Engineer - B² - India



September 2nd, 2024

Kai Ekkart - Java Software Engineer - B² - Belgium (via internship)



October 1st, 2024

Michael Fernandez-Juarez - Software Engineer - B² - Belgium (via internship)



October 1st, 2024

Sam Lemmens - Graphic Designer/Marketing Assistant - B² - Belgium



Subcontractors

June 10th, 2024

Bert Jacobs - .NET Software Engineer @Atlas Copco (GEMS) - Belgium

Internship

September 30th, 2024 - December 23rd, 2024

Bryan Langhendries - Montova Software Engineer (Java / React) - Belgium



Feel free to send any ideas for new topics, suggestions or comments to [Nathalie](#)